

Stravinsky found a positive musical response to both situations in a sequence of works that could be performed more easily on smaller budgets. The composer showed a deepening awareness of his linguistic and musical roots, particularly Russian folk song—as in the sung and danced ballet *Les Noces* (The Wedding), featuring an onstage chorus and an “orchestra” of four pianos and percussion instruments, which reached its final form in 1923.

By then, Stravinsky had settled in postwar Paris. Moving beyond dissonant Modernism toward a cooler Neo-Classicism, his music now increasingly looked to adapt and transmute earlier styles. The ballet *Pulcinella* (staged by Diaghilev’s revived company in 1920) was based on keyboard works supposedly by the Italian composer Pergolesi, though these are now known to be imitations. Needing to support his widowed mother, his own exiled family, and the family of his aunt (Catherine’s mother), Stravinsky often appeared as a concert pianist in his own works, among them a piano concerto, and the *Capriccio* for piano and orchestra. Other major statements were a ritualized opera, *Oedipus Rex*, adapted from Sophocles’ ancient Greek play *King Oedipus*, and the choral and orchestral *Symphony of Psalms*. Both works used texts in Latin, whose depersonalized, “dead language” properties appealed to Stravinsky’s anti-Romantic streak. The *Symphony of Psalms*, written for the Boston Symphony Orchestra, marked the composer’s return—after many years of rejection—to the Russian Orthodox faith of his upbringing.